



SESSION 5 — MENTOR GUIDE

Dealing with Setbacks

Not every setback has been processed. Hold space for emotion. Hero stories are nice but processing comes first.

SESSION GOAL

Help the athlete reframe setbacks as learning opportunities and discover their personal resilience pattern.

CONVERSATION FLOW

OPENING (5 MIN)

""Everyone has had a setback that really hurt. What was yours?""

💡 Be patient. This can become quiet. That's okay.

EXPLORING (15 MIN)

""How did you take care of yourself in that period? What helped you?""

💡 Focus on resilience, not on suffering. "How did YOU get through that period?"

DEEPENING (10 MIN)

""Looking back — what did that period give you that you wouldn't otherwise have?""

💡 Post-traumatic growth. Don't push if the athlete isn't there yet. Feel the timing.

CLOSING (5 MIN)

""What do you want to take from your own resilience story for the next time things get hard?""

💡 Let the athlete formulate their own resilience recipe.



OBSERVE

- Does the athlete talk about the setback in past tense (processed) or present tense (still active)?
- Is there guilt (internal) or blame (external)? Which is healthier — and which is more honest?
- Did the athlete have a support network? Is it still there now?
- Note: if someone truly cannot talk about it or becomes very emotional, hold space — and make an internal note.

△ NOTE

Setbacks can be traumatic. You are not a therapist. If an athlete shares something beyond your competence (mental health crisis, abuse, serious loss), refer with care: "This deserves more attention than we can offer here. I know someone who can really help you."

CLOSING

Acknowledge the courage: "Thank you for sharing this. That takes courage." Close with the athlete's resilience sentence — let them say it out loud.

MENTOR NOTES